From May beginning to end-September is the *slack season* and from October beginning to end-April is the *busy season* of the ***Indian economy***. During the slack season, crops are generally sown. Agriculture and related businesses are slack and loans taken during the previous busy season tend to be returned. Consequently, the growth rate of money is low or negative. Governments usually borrow heavily during the slack season, since the demand for credit from the commercial sector is not very strong. Since there are no fresh crop arrivals in the market and the demand for crops is steady, the prices are expected to be generally upward in the slack season.

From October, the busy season commences and both agricultural and related industrial productions are high. Since crops arrive in the market during the busy season, prices generally are on the downward drift. It is the seasonal variation in the arrival of crops in the market, in the context of steady demand, that causes prices to fluctuate during the year.

The above pattern has been severely modified in recent years. The government borrows both during the slack and the busy seasons. Industry too is active in both the seasons. Because of greater storage and stocking facilities, the variations in the flows o f agricultural products have been reduced. Money supply expands continuously and prices are generally up throughout.

BUYER'S MARKET

A short period of market situation in which there is excess supply of goods/services forcing price fall to the advantage of the buyers.

BUYOUTS

Private equity (PE) investors participate in two types of buyouts of firms (a PE-backed buyout simply means that the PE investor takes a controlling stake i.e. between 50–100 per cent in a company):

(i) *Management Buyout (MBO):* In such buyouts, the PE investor usually helps the existing management of the company to buy out